Maa's Operational App — How we finalize

Target launch: Monday Nov 16, 2026. First, Aslam fills in the Google Sheet "Maa's Operational App - Info Needed" (59 items; 11 answered Oct 13). The preview app shows the look; real data replaces the samples.

Phases

Phase	Dates	Who does what	Decision point
1. Fill in & decide	Oct 14 – Oct 23	Aslam fills the 'Info Needed' sheet (Decisions + People first by Oct 16). Aslam picks the build option by Oct 23.	Decision point: sections, build option, texting yes/no
2. Set up data	Oct 19 – Oct 27	Staff fills inventory counts. Assistant loads menu, vendors (Al Markaz, Popeyes, Chef Chen), deliveries (The Bridge, Austin Street, street handout) and shifts. Aslam sends vendor numbers privately; Twilio account + texting registration started.	Aslam checks the data sheet
3. Build test app	Oct 26 – Oct 30	Assistant connects the preview to the real (private) data with sign-in for owners/admins.	Aslam approves the test app
4. Test	Nov 2 – Nov 6	2 admins + 3–5 volunteers use it on a real Saturday (Oct 31 or Nov 7): check-in, hours, menu, counts.	Collect feedback
5. Fix & train	Nov 9 – Nov 13	Assistant fixes issues; 15-minute how-to for admins; kiosk set up on a tablet.	Aslam gives go/no-go Nov 13
6. Launch	Mon Nov 16, 2026	Share link with admins and volunteers; first live week; check in after first Saturday.	—

Build options

Option	Cost	How it works	Notes
A. Google Sheet + our own web app (recommended)	$0/month	Private Google Sheet holds the data; Apps Script with sign-in; the app you saw (works on phone/desktop, installable). We already run the checklist this way.	Assistant builds; changes need the Assistant
B. AppSheet (Google)	Free if Maa's gets Google Workspace for Nonprofits (includes AppSheet Core); otherwise Starter $5 or Core $10 per user/month	Point-and-click app on a Google Sheet. Free editor with up to 10 test users.	Easy for staff to edit; per-user cost without Workspace
C. Glide	Classic Maker $60/mo ($49/yr) or Business $249/mo (30 users); GlideOS from $25/mo	No-code app on a Google Sheet	Good looks; highest cost

Texting: YES (Aslam approved Oct 13)

Vendor orders are texted from the app to Al Markaz, Popeyes and Chef Chen (numbers still needed). Plan: Twilio, registered for US business texting during phase 2 (approval can take days to weeks). Costs: $0.0083 per text + carrier fee (~$0.0035–$0.0045) ≈ 1.2¢ per text; phone number from $1.15/mo; US business-texting registration ~$4.50 brand + $15 campaign (one-time) + $1.50–$10/mo. Example: 4 vendor texts + 50 volunteer reminders a week ≈ 220 texts/mo ≈ $3 + fees. Until registration is approved, the app shows the order to copy into a normal text.

Recommendation: Option A ($0). Vendor orders by text through Twilio (approved). Volunteer reminders by free email unless texting is wanted too. Apply for Google Workspace for Nonprofits (free) so app data lives in a Maa's account, not a personal Gmail.

Answered Oct 13: all 6 sections · all 3 programs · Aslam Owner; Anila, Amyna, Noushin Admins (confirm) · vendors Al Markaz, Popeyes, Chef Chen · menu from Drive sheet · deliveries: The Bridge, Austin Street, street handout · texting yes · Al Markaz 7 large dishes per item weekly · Maa's Meals shift Sat 10–11:30 AM, ~30 volunteers.
Still needed first: vendor phone numbers · dish repeat rule · Maa's Place + BSV shifts · stock counts · sign-in method · who sees volunteer contacts.

Prices checked Oct 13, 2026: twilio.com/en-us/sms/pricing/us, twilio.com/en-us/phone-numbers/a2p-10dlc, about.appsheet.com/pricing, support.google.com/a/answer/10100275, glideapps.com/classic/pricing, glideapps.com/pricing.